

**This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.**

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Mysimba (Naltrexone 8mg / Bupropion 90mg) prolonged-release tablets for the treatment of obesity

## Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for obesity

### Overview

Obesity is a chronic disease affecting a significant proportion of the population. Clinical assessment should include measurement of weight, height and calculation of body mass index (BMI), waist circumference, and assessment of cardiovascular risk.

- **Management approach:** The primary management of obesity involves lifestyle intervention with a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity. Pharmacological interventions, including Mysimba, should be considered as adjunctive therapy in patients who have not achieved adequate weight loss through lifestyle measures alone.

### Pharmacological treatment

Mysimba (naltrexone/bupropion combination) is a second-line pharmacological option for weight management in adults with obesity who have not achieved adequate weight loss with lifestyle intervention alone.

- **Indication:** Adjunct to a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity for weight management in adults with initial BMI  $\geq 30$  kg/m<sup>2</sup> or  $\geq 27$  kg/m<sup>2</sup> in the presence of at least one weight-related comorbidity.
- **Duration of treatment:** Treatment should be reviewed at 16 weeks. If weight loss of at least 5% has not been achieved by 16 weeks, Mysimba should be discontinued.

## Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

**Mysimba (Naltrexone 8mg / Bupropion 90mg) prolonged-release tablets**

for the treatment of

**obesity**

### Healthcare professionals covered and training

|                                 | Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Qualifications and Registration | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC</li><li>• Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC</li></ul> |
| Training and assessment         | Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be                                        |

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|                                              | <p>documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team.</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines</li> <li>• All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication</li> <li>• Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer</li> <li>• All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service</li> </ul> |
| <b>Further training and responsibilities</b> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal</li> <li>• All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products</li> <li>• All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                         |

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| <b>PGD Indication</b>     | Adjunct to a reduced-calorie diet and increased physical activity for weight management in adults with initial BMI $\geq 30$ kg/m <sup>2</sup> or $\geq 27$ kg/m <sup>2</sup> with at least one weight-related comorbidity (such as type 2 diabetes, hypertension, dyslipidaemia, or sleep apnoea).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Inclusion criteria</b> | <p>Age 18 years and over</p> <p>BMI <math>\geq 30</math> kg/m<sup>2</sup> or <math>\geq 27</math> kg/m<sup>2</sup> with at least one weight-related comorbidity</p> <p>Documented failed weight loss attempt through lifestyle intervention (reduced-calorie diet and physical activity) for at least 3 months</p> <p>Able to provide informed written consent</p> <p>Not currently pregnant or breast-feeding; females of childbearing potential should use effective contraception</p> <p>Resting blood pressure &lt;140/90 mmHg (if <math>\geq 140/90</math> mmHg, refer to GP for management before initiating Mysimba)</p>                                           |
| <b>Exclusion criteria</b> | <p>Uncontrolled hypertension (blood pressure <math>\geq 140/90</math> mmHg) or history of significant cardiovascular disease</p> <p>Seizure disorders or history of seizures or head trauma with loss of consciousness</p> <p>CNS tumour or history of CNS tumour</p> <p>Abrupt discontinuation of alcohol or benzodiazepines, or concurrent use of benzodiazepines or alcohol withdrawal</p> <p>Current opioid use or opioid dependence; do not use within 7-10 days of opioid discontinuation</p> <p>Use of monoamine oxidase inhibitors (MAOIs) or within 14 days of MAOI discontinuation</p> <p>History of eating disorders (bulimia nervosa or anorexia nervosa)</p> |

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|                                                             | <p>Severe hepatic impairment (Child-Pugh Class C)</p> <p>End-stage renal failure (eGFR &lt;15 mL/min/1.73m<sup>2</sup>)</p> <p>Bipolar disorder or major depressive disorder with suicidal ideation</p> <p>Known hypersensitivity to naltrexone, bupropion, or any excipients</p> <p>Angle-closure glaucoma</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Cautions</b>                                             | <p>Hypertension: Monitor blood pressure regularly (at least monthly initially). Bupropion may elevate blood pressure; discontinue if sustained elevation occurs.</p> <p>Hepatic impairment: Use with caution in mild to moderate hepatic impairment. Avoid in severe impairment.</p> <p>Renal impairment: Use with caution in moderate to severe renal impairment; dose adjustment may be required.</p> <p>Elderly patients: Use with caution; dose adjustment may be necessary due to age-related changes in metabolism.</p> <p>Suicidal ideation and behaviour: Monitor for mood changes, depression, anxiety, and suicidal thoughts, particularly in the first weeks of treatment and following any dose adjustment.</p> <p>Seizure threshold: Bupropion lowers seizure threshold; avoid concurrent use of medications that lower seizure threshold. Caution in patients with CNS conditions.</p> <p>Blood glucose: May affect glucose control in diabetic patients; monitor blood glucose closely and adjust antidiabetic medication if necessary.</p> <p>Concurrent medications: Potential for drug interactions with medications metabolised by CYP2D6, antidepressants, and other CNS-active drugs; review all medications before initiating.</p> <p>Angle-closure glaucoma risk: Bupropion may increase intraocular pressure; caution in patients at risk of angle-closure glaucoma.</p> <p>Tachycardia: Monitor heart rate; bupropion may increase heart rate or cause tachycardia.</p> |
| <b>Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment</b> | <p>Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed.</p> <p>Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

#### **Details of the medicine**

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|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name, form and strength of medicine</b> | Mysimba tablets containing naltrexone hydrochloride 8mg and bupropion hydrochloride 90mg (prolonged-release) |
| <b>Legal category</b>                      | POM (Prescription Only Medicine)                                                                             |
| <b>Storage</b>                             | Store below 30°C. Keep in original container.                                                                |
| <b>Route/method of administration</b>      | Oral. Swallow tablets whole. Do not crush, chew, or divide tablets.                                          |

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|                                                    | Can be taken with or without food (avoid high-fat meals).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Dose and frequency</b>                          | <p>Titration over 4 weeks:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Week 1: One tablet once daily in the morning</li> <li>• Week 2: One tablet in the morning and one tablet in the evening</li> <li>• Week 3: Two tablets in the morning and one tablet in the evening</li> <li>• Week 4 onwards (maintenance): Two tablets in the morning and two tablets in the evening (maximum 4 tablets per day, 2 twice daily)</li> </ul> <p>After titration, the dose should be maintained at 4 tablets daily (2 tablets twice daily) unless dosage adjustment is required.</p>                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Quantity to be administered and/or supplied</b> | Up to 120 tablets (28-day supply at full maintenance dose of 4 tablets daily). Quantity may be adjusted based on individual patient circumstances and treatment duration.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Maximum or minimum treatment period</b>         | Review at 16 weeks of treatment. Discontinue if <5% body weight loss achieved. Maximum treatment period should be determined based on continued clinical benefit and tolerability.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Adverse effects</b>                             | <p>Very common (<math>\geq 1/10</math>): Nausea, constipation, headache, insomnia</p> <p>Common (<math>\geq 1/100</math> to <math>&lt; 1/10</math>): Vomiting, dry mouth, dizziness, anxiety, tremor, upper abdominal pain, tachycardia, hypertension, decreased appetite, rash, pruritus</p> <p>Uncommon (<math>\geq 1/1,000</math> to <math>&lt; 1/100</math>): Seizures, fever, agitation, abnormal dreams, palpitations, sweating, dyspepsia</p> <p>Serious adverse effects (report immediately): Seizures, severe hypertension, hepatotoxicity (jaundice, elevated liver enzymes), severe allergic reactions (including angioedema), suicidal ideation or behaviour, severe mood changes</p> |

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| <b>Yellow card reporting</b> | Report suspected adverse effects via <a href="https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk">https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk</a> and inform the GP as appropriate.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Records to be kept</b>    | <p>Record the following information:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• that valid informed consent was given</li> <li>• name of individual, address, date of birth and GP</li> <li>• name of healthcare practitioner</li> <li>• name and brand of medication</li> <li>• date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied</li> <li>• advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment</li> <li>• details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD</li> </ul> <p>Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made.</p> <p>A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should</p> |

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|  | <p>also be kept for audit purposes as follows:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years</li> <li>Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)</li> </ul> |
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### **Patient information**

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| <b>Written information to be given to patient or carer</b> | Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with Mysimba. Provide written information regarding the dose titration schedule, lifestyle modifications (reduced-calorie diet and physical activity), and emergency contact details.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer</b>    | <p>Swallow tablets whole; do not crush, chew, or divide them.</p> <p>Follow the dose titration schedule carefully over the first 4 weeks; do not increase the dose faster than prescribed.</p> <p>Take the medication as prescribed even if you do not see immediate results; weight loss may take several weeks to become apparent.</p> <p>Maintain a reduced-calorie diet and engage in regular physical activity as directed by your healthcare provider or dietitian.</p> <p>Report any mood changes, depression, anxiety, suicidal thoughts, or unusual behaviour immediately to your healthcare provider or emergency services.</p> <p>Monitor your blood pressure regularly at home if possible; report any persistent elevation to your GP.</p> <p>Do not consume excessive alcohol as it may increase the risk of seizures and adverse effects.</p> <p>Avoid high-fat meals as they may affect absorption; take with water.</p> <p>Do not stop the medication abruptly; discuss discontinuation with your healthcare provider.</p> <p>Inform all healthcare providers (including dentists) that you are taking Mysimba, as it may interact with other medications.</p> <p>If you experience persistent insomnia, headache, nausea, or constipation, discuss management options with your healthcare provider.</p> <p>Attend all follow-up appointments as scheduled, particularly the review at 16 weeks to assess weight loss and tolerability.</p> <p>Report any allergic reactions (rash, itching, swelling) or chest pain to your healthcare provider or seek emergency care immediately.</p> |

### **Key references**

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using

patient group directions. Updated March 2017  
<https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>

- NICE CKS Guidance: Weight management in obesity
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines

### Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|---------------------|-----------|
| Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates |             |                     |           |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
| Name of healthcare professional                                                   | Job title   | Registration number | Signature |
|                                                                                   |             |                     |           |
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| Valid from date                                                                   | Expiry date |                     |           |
| 1/11/25                                                                           | 31/10/26    |                     |           |

### PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

|                                        |                                          |                                                                                      |            |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| Name of superintendent / clinical lead | Job title & name of organisation         | Signature                                                                            | Date       |
| Chris Pilkington                       | Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health Limited |  | 19/06/2026 |

|                                      |                                                          |                                                                                    |            |
|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
|                                      | (GPhC: 2046322)                                          |                                                                                    |            |
| Name of professional group signatory | Job title & name of organisation                         | Signature                                                                          | Date       |
| Chris Pilkington                     | Head Pharmacist, Get Real Health Limited (GPhC: 2046322) |  | 19/06/2026 |

#### Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

| Name             | Qualification                  | Signature                                                                          | Date    |
|------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| Nitin Shori      | Medical Doctor<br>GMC: 6047293 |   | 2/11/25 |
| Chris Pilkington | Pharmacist<br>GPhC: 2046322    |  | 2/11/25 |

#### Change history

| Version number | Change details                 | Date              |
|----------------|--------------------------------|-------------------|
| 001            | Development & issue of new PGD | 1st November 2025 |
|                |                                |                   |
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